



Furman University Equestrian Team Constitution

Updated January 15, 2018

Article I. Membership

Any Furman University student can join the club. There will be tryouts held at the beginning of each semester for the show team which competes in IHSA competitions.

Article II. Lessons

Each member will be put into a weekly group lesson at the beginning of each semester. Lesson groups will be based on class schedule and skill level. Lessons cost \$40 due at the time of the lesson. All members are required to sign into their lessons in the designated sign in book when they attend. It is expected that members inform the trainers no less than 12 hours in advance if they will miss their lesson. If a member misses their lesson without informing the trainer(s) within two hours of the lesson's time, they will be expected to pay for that lesson in full. Missed lessons can be made up in another group lesson or in a private lesson. The member is responsible for contacting the trainer(s) to set up a time to make up their lesson. However, excessive absences (excused or not) may lead to dismissal from the show team.

Article III. Meetings

Meetings will be required for either the show team or the entire club as specified by officers. If a member is unable to attend a meeting, they must notify the secretary at least 24 hours in advance with a valid excuse for it to be considered excused. Late excuses will be considered unexcused. The officers, on a case-by-case basis, will determine what constitutes acceptable excuses. Examples of excused absences: sickness, class or test, family emergency, team practices, etc. Examples of unexcused absences: date, too much homework, a CLP (unless required by a class), etc. We ask that you try to schedule things (like work) around these meetings, but this can be discussed with the officers individually. However, excessive absences (excused or not) may lead to dismissal from the show team.

Article IV. Show Team

Tryouts will be held in the first two weeks of lessons and decisions will be made by the trainer(s). For each show class riders will be ranked at the beginning of the semester in order of trainer preference for shows. Decisions on members showing will be made by trainers within a week of particular show and are completely at the discretion of the trainers. An IHSA membership fee (\$40 for each member) is required upon registration each year that you are trying out for the team. All members who pay the membership fee and attend the lessons required to tryout are considered for the show team and showing opportunities. To maintain membership once joined, a person must have at least 4 lessons a month with the trainer(s) at the team barn. Exceptions will be made on a case-by-case basis decided on by the officers. In order to show, a member must have made up all missed lessons and attend the meeting prior to the show, unless excused. Show team members will be required to pay fees for shows or show team required apparel as specified by the officers. All show team members will sign a contract at the beginning of the season agreeing to the terms of the team.

Article V. Shows

The president and one other officer will be present in the draw at each show. There is to be no alcohol or other illegal substances consumed from the time the team leaves for a show to the time

the team returns to campus. Members competing at shows must travel to shows at the time specified for that show by the officers. Members may not leave from shows unless in special circumstances as decided on by officers and trainers. Members should attend all team events during shows as well as stay with the team in the case of an overnight show. Appropriate show clothes, defined in the IHSA rulebook, should be worn when showing. Show team should sport team apparel at shows when not showing. Good sportsmanlike conduct, as well as support of specified show buddy, is expected.

Article VI. Officers

Officer elections will be held at the beginning of the spring semester of each year. All officer nominations can be made by any team member and will be voted on by the team at a team meeting. Presidential nominations will happen in a two step process. Members interested in the position will alert current president of interest and then those individuals will go through a slating process. Two seniors (highest officer positions or selected by the team) and trainers will meet to choose two of these individuals to present to the team as options for president. Team will then vote as normal. Additionally, trainers will place individual votes for all positions and select tiebreaker votes prior to elections meeting. Three-fourths majority attendance is required for voting. The position will be given to the nominated member who receives a majority of the votes. If an officer is seen as unfit to do his/her job, the other officers may vote to have him/her step down at any time. Following this, a nomination and vote to fill the position will be held at the next team meeting. President will be the only officer that is guaranteed a spot at shows in order to ensure an officer is present. President will only be guaranteed one show class if he/she is eligible for more than one. In order to vote, a member must be present or have their absence excused. Requirements and descriptions of officer positions are listed below.

VI. A. Requirements for officer positions

In order to be eligible to hold an officer position, a team member must have had at least one semester experience on the team. President must have held an officer position prior. This member must be in good standing with the team when it comes to meeting and lesson attendance. In addition to the regular team meeting, they must be willing to attend a officers meetings (time to be determined by officers).

VI. B. Officer descriptions and expectations

Responsibilities may be re-delegated at any officer meeting if agreed upon by the president and relevant officer(s).

President- leads officer and regular meetings; organizes paperwork for registration at the beginning of school year; communicates with Leslie and Muffin on a regular basis about team members and lesson progress; handles disputes and problems between members, officers, and trainers; creates and manages lesson schedule at the beginning of each semester; registers for and maintains organization at horse shows; delegates other responsibilities and ensures other officers are doing their duties; attends the draw at shows; attends required club sports meetings; sends weekly team email including updates and schedule; assists in creating budget; is able to request money from Club Sports Director; keeps minutes for each meeting to send out to those absent

Vice President- in charge of involvement fair, open house, and closing house activities; organizes team-bonding activities; plans and acquires senior and trainer gifts; acts in the absence of president at meetings and/or horse shows; reserves rooms for

meetings; plans show team dinners; assigns show buddies and hotel rooms; keeps record of lesson and meeting attendance;

Treasurer- creates and manages budget and budget request forms; turns in receipts for reimbursements; requests entry fees for shows and brings checks to show; keeps in communication with Club Sports Director and president to make sure everything financial is done in a timely manner; in charge of collecting and holding show team fees; books hotel rooms for shows; in charge of fundraising;

Public Relations- keeps all social media accounts up to date, including: SyncDin, Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Snapchat, and Website; organizes team apparel days; makes flyers and informational pamphlets; organizes yearly photo-shoot; organizes apparel orders; posts meeting and important information on SyncDin; acquires food donations for shows; creates a bi-monthly alumni newsletter; improves team's relationship with the greater Greenville community; promotes team unity within IHSA; writes thank you notes for host schools after shows

Article VII. Dismissal from the team

A member will be dismissed from the show team if the trainer(s) and/or the officers determine that the member has excessive and inexcusable absences from lessons and/or meetings, if they show intolerable and unsportsmanlike conduct, or irresponsible and dangerous behaviors at any team-related activity or location (the barn, hotel or traveling for shows, etc.). If a member is dismissed from the show team, they will not be allowed to compete through the end of the season but may still practice and participate in the club. A member will be dismissed from the club entirely if the trainer(s) or the officers determine that the member has engaged in something inappropriate, dangerous, or unsportsmanlike that cannot be overlooked and negatively impacts the team, such as multiple offenses of the above. All members are encouraged to bring to the officer's attention any experience where another member has committed one of the above offenses. All dismissals will be voted on in a confidential meeting with all officers and trainers with a majority ruling. The member in consideration will be notified and given the opportunity to defend his/her situation. If a member is dismissed from the team entirely, they will not be allowed to join the team again at any point in the future nor would they be allowed to continue lessons/boarding at the barn at which the team practices.

Article VIII. Selecting a barn

The officers may choose to relocate barns by a unanimous vote in an officer's meeting. They will then select possible barns in the area to be considered. Location, trainer(s) qualifications, facilities, and cost will be taken into consideration. The president and at least one other officer should schedule a time to meet with the trainer(s) and tour each barn in a timely manner. They will report back to the officers their opinions of each. At the next team meeting, the team will vote which barn to attend after hearing the officer's descriptions and an in-depth conversation about each. Three-fourths majority attendance is required for voting. The barn with the majority of votes will be chosen as the team's new barn.

Article VIX. The Constitution

The constitution is to be updated yearly by the President and Vice President prior to new officer elections. New officers cannot update the constitution until the end of their term, unless a special circumstance which is to be approved by trainers. Constitution will be sent out to team members at

the beginning of each semester and voted on by the team. Majority vote is needed to approve the constitution.